

**Medford Public Schools
Medford, Massachusetts
Medford School Committee
Committee of the Whole
Personnel
January 24, 2013
7:00 p.m.
Superintendent's Conference Room
Medford High School**

The meeting was called to order by Personnel Subcommittee Chairperson Paulette Van der Kloot at 7:03 p.m. Members present: Ann Marie Cugno, Erin DiBenedetto, John Falco, George Scarpelli, Robert E. Skerry Jr., and Paulette Van der Kloot. 6-0-1 (abs) Also present: Superintendent Belson, Assistant Superintendent Caldwell, and Director of Finance and Administration Ann Giombetti.

All rose to salute the Flag.

Chairperson Van der Kloot stated the purpose of the meeting was to review current personnel matters. Also that the School Committee may go into executive session to deal with bargaining and contract issues affecting both management and administrative personnel. The Chairperson then called upon Superintendent Belson for an overview.

Superintendent Belson distributed three reports as follows:

- Medford Public Schools staff summary by bargaining unit with salaries
- A listing of 16 personnel challenges facing the School Committee in the near future
- A listing of Administration proposed personnel goals

All three reports are attached to these meeting minutes.

Discussion began with the first report listing all personnel. Committee members asked various questions to clarify items in the listing.

The Superintendent pointed out where cuts had affected staffing levels in recent years and the need to begin restorations to meet operational demands. The emphasis has been on retaining our teaching capacity.

This led to a robust discussion of the challenges facing our school system in the current tense and near future. The listing speaks for itself and Committee members acknowledged the identified items.

The Superintendent announced that he has received the retirement notice of Vocational School Director William Mahoney effective at the close of this school year. Since the recent Committee of the Whole discussed vocational issues, this item was of concern.

The Superintendent indicated that a search for a new director would begin shortly. However, it was important for the Committee to continue its review of the program so that the new director would be compatible with the Committee's vision for vocational education.

The Superintendent then discussed his ten proposed personnel goals recognizing that the Committee may have some additional or different items. The focus was on stability, building capacity, and transition.

Committee members reviewed each of the items with the Superintendent and for the most part there was agreement. The Committee reserved the right to develop some of its own ideas going forward as well.

On the motion of Mr. Skerry, seconded by Ms. DiBenedetto the School Committee voted 6-0-1 (abs) to enter executive session at 8:17 p.m. The purpose was to deal with bargaining and contract issues as they affect management and administrative personnel. The Chairperson announced that the Committee would return to open session.

The Committee returned to open session at 9:55 p.m.

On the motion of Mr. Skerry seconded by Mr. Falco:
The Superintendent prepare a detailed listing of management and administrative personnel that indicates their current contractual status and their last salary increase.
Voted 6-0-1 (abs)

On the motion of Mr. Falco seconded by Ms. DiBenedetto:
The Superintendent provide the School Committee with a hybrid evaluation instrument that coordinates the current system of Superintendent's evaluation with the new emerging system of evaluation.

The Committee discussed various options with the idea that this year was a transition year for evaluations and that it would be helpful to move in the direction of the new system. However, since the new system requires a full year of planning it would not be reasonable to switch completely over mid-year.
Voted 6-0-1 (abs)

The Committee reflected on the need to establish stability as soon as possible and asked the Superintendent to expedite the process.

On the motion of Mr. Skerry seconded by Mr. Scarpelli:
The meeting was adjourned at 10:16 p.m.

Respectfully Submitted

Paulette Van der Kloot

